JC already builds robots that win. Hack 876 gives more JC boys one day to build.



Hack 876 is a one-day build competition bringing about 80 Jamaican secondary-school students together to turn ideas into working prototypes.

01 ALREADY ON BOARD

Campion College and Hillel Academy are already in.

The inaugural Hack 876 is taking shape. We would like JC students in the room with them.



Campion College

CONFIRMED SCHOOL



Hillel Academy

CONFIRMED SCHOOL

7 CONFIRMED JUDGES

Working at Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

FREE FOR STUDENTS

No cost to apply. Food is provided on the day.

VENUE CONFIRMED

Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston.

SUPPORTED BY

Lev Beauty, Vault Motors, Norus Technologies, Frankies.

02 WHY JC

Jamaica College already builds.

In 2023 JC's Bluebots won Jamaica's FIRST Tech Challenge championship with the Inspire Award, then became the first Jamaican team to win the MOTIVATE Award at the World Championship in Houston.

Hack 876 adds something a timetable cannot easily provide: students from other schools, a fixed deadline, mentors from industry, and judges who ask students to explain their decisions. Teams can build software, AI tools or hardware, so JC's robotics and STEAM students have room to bring what they already know.



Floreat Collegium, Fervet Opus in Campis
May the College flourish; work is burning in the fields.

Robotics
The Bluebots took the Inspire Award at FTC Jamaica 2023, and JC's Griffins won the Design Award.

World stage
The MOTIVATE Award at the 2023 FIRST World Championship, a first for a Jamaican team.

JC STEAMING UP
A school-wide STEAM programme since 2021, with 3D printers, drones, robots and project-based learning rooms.

Host school
JC hosted the 2025 FTC Jamaica National Robotics Championship, with 34 schools.

> **"We want to add to that the skills that will enhance the boys' abilities to go out into the world of work."**
>
> Mr. Wayne Robinson, Principal, Jamaica College · Jamaica Observer, August 2024

One day. Build something real.

~80 TOTAL BUILDERS

3–4 PER TEAM

1 DAY

A hackathon is an event where small teams build something from scratch in a single day, then present it to judges. No programming experience is needed: teams also need students who design, research, write and present. Mentors who work in industry help throughout the day.

STEP 1
Think
Find a real problem worth solving.

STEP 2
Build
Turn the idea into a working prototype.

STEP 3
Ship
Get it running before the clock stops.

STEP 4
Present
Demo it to judges and explain the decisions.

Websites · Apps · AI tools · Games · Hardware · Data projects · Automations · Agents · Interactive experiences

Not an AI-only hackathon. Teams build whatever the problem needs.

04 WHAT STUDENTS GAIN

More than a project.

It won't decide anyone's career. It gives students a useful early signal about whether building technology excites them.

Teamwork
Working with people who think differently.

Scoping
Learning what can really be built in a day.

Technical problem solving
Turning a concept into something that works.

Decision making
Choosing between ideas under real constraints.

Communication
Explaining what they built to judges and peers.

Resilience
Shipping something even when it isn't perfect.

Exposure
Meeting students and professionals beyond their usual circle.

Confidence
Moving from using technology to making it.

05 PARTICIPATION

JC in the room.

Hack 876 is for students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form. Participating schools recommend students, and recommended students apply. No place is assumed until applications and selection happen.

8–12

PLANNING RANGE · NOT GUARANTEED

For early planning, a cohort of roughly 8–12 JC students fits the scale we're considering. With about 80 places across participating schools, final representation depends on applications and overall capacity.

Teams of 3–4. Students can apply solo or with friends, and teams may mix schools. Final team-formation rules are still being finalized.

WHAT WE'D LIKE FROM JC

1. A 20-minute call with Mr. Robinson, or a faculty leader he nominates.
2. Support in principle for eligible JC boys, in 5th Form through Upper 6th, to take part.
3. A school-side contact, possibly from the team behind JC STEAMING UP.
4. Help reaching boys in robotics, the STEM Club, IT, the sciences, digital arts and business.
5. Guidance on permissions and communication with parents.

We're not asking JC for financial support, or to organize anything. Hack 876 runs the event, the applications, the judging and the participant materials.

06 COMPETITION

Build it. Present it. Compete for it.

Prizes across overall placement and special categories. The exact package will keep developing as sponsors are finalized, and participating schools will get updates.

OVERALL PLACEMENT

Hack 876 Winner
The whole thing. Best overall build.
iPad per student (up to 4)

Second Place
So close. Still brilliant.
AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)

Third Place
On the podium.
US$150 gift card per student (up to 4)

SPECIAL AWARDS

Best Design
Looks great. Feels even better.
US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Boldest Idea
The swing nobody else took.
US$200 team project grant

People's Choice
Voted by the room.
US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Categories are set. Prize items are tentative and may change. Prizes are a bonus, not the reason to come.

07 WORKING WITH JC

Twenty minutes to start.

We would like JC to be part of the first Hack 876. The first step is a short call with the school's leadership.

PREPARED FOR

Mr. Wayne Robinson

Principal · Jamaica College

Principal of Jamaica College

We'd welcome 20 minutes with Mr. Robinson, or with a faculty leader he nominates, to walk through what taking part would involve.



The Hack 876 organizing team runs event operations, applications and all official communication with students and parents.

This is an invitation. Jamaica College has not confirmed participation, nobody at JC has accepted a role, and student places are not guaranteed.

THE ONE THING WE'RE ASKING FOR NOW

A 20-minute call with Mr. Robinson, or a faculty leader he nominates.

Reply to the email this came with, or write to info@hack876.com, and we'll work around your timetable.

We'll fill in the details together.

JC doesn't need every answer today to join the conversation.

FIRST
A 20-minute call with Mr. Robinson or a faculty leader he nominates.

IF JC AGREES
Support in principle, and a school-side contact.

THEN
Teachers share the opportunity, and boys apply.

BEFORE THE EVENT
Accepted students and their families receive consent forms.

EVENT DAY
Hack 876.

DECIDED

- One-day build competition
- Venue: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston
- 5th Form through Upper 6th Form
- About 80 places
- Schools recommend, students apply
- Applications are open

PLANNED

- Tentative date: Saturday, February 20, 2027
- A 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM day
- Lunch on the day
- Overall and special prize categories
- Industry judges and mentors

BEING FINALIZED

- Confirming the date
- School-level allocations and team rules
- Cost and transport
- Prize items
- Family details: supervision, food, emergency contacts

Participating schools and applicants will receive detailed information as each part of the event is finalized.

FLOREAT COLLEGIUM, FERVET OPUS IN CAMPIS · MAY THE COLLEGE FLOURISH; WORK IS BURNING IN THE FIELDS.

At JC, work is burning in the fields. Let's give a few JC boys one day to build something real.

HACK 876 · KINGSTON, JAMAICA · FEB 20, 2027 (TENTATIVE)

info@hack876.com

ABOUT JC: SOURCES

1. Jamaica College: JC STEAMING UP (updated March 2026)
2. Jamaica Observer: Bluebots from JC win NCB Foundation FTC Jamaica Robotics Championship (March 11, 2023)
3. Jamaica Observer: JC makes history as first Jamaican team to win MOTIVATE Award (April 2023)
4. Jamaica Information Service: FIRST Tech Challenge Jamaica Championship at JC (March 2025)
5. Jamaica Observer: JC principal introduces practical skills for students (August 21, 2024)
6. Jamaica College: Guiding tenets and symbols

Prepared by Hack 876 for the JC community. This is not an official Jamaica College publication, and JC's participation has not been confirmed. Dates, allocations and prizes are provisional.